

# MERIDIAN & ASSOCIATES LLP

Advisory | Assurance | Tax | Consulting

## Client Relationship Profile

ACME Manufacturing Corporation

**CONFIDENTIAL**

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Meridian & Associates LLP | New York | Chicago | San Francisco | London | Singapore

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## 1. Client Overview

**Client Name:** ACME Manufacturing Corporation

**Industry:** Diversified Manufacturing (Industrial Equipment, Aerospace Components, Automotive Parts)

**Headquarters:** Detroit, MI

**Annual Revenue:** \$4.8 billion (FY2025)

**Employees:** 18,500 globally

**Publicly Traded:** Yes -- NYSE: ACMM

**Global Operations:** Manufacturing facilities in US (6), Mexico (2), Germany (1), China (1), India (1)

**Fiscal Year End:** December 31

**Relationship Partner:** Sarah Chen, CPA, CISA

**Relationship Start Date:** October 2017

**Relationship Tenure:** 8+ years

## 2. Relationship History

Meridian & Associates LLP has served ACME Manufacturing Corporation since October 2017, beginning with an internal audit co-sourcing engagement. The relationship has expanded significantly over time, and ACME is now one of Meridian's Top 50 clients by revenue, with annual fees exceeding \$8.2 million across multiple service lines.

### Timeline of Engagements

- **2017 (Q4):** Internal Audit Co-Sourcing -- engaged to supplement ACME's internal audit function with 6 dedicated professionals. Scope included SOX 404 testing, operational audits, and compliance reviews.
- **2018 (Q2):** IT Risk Assessment -- comprehensive assessment of cybersecurity posture across 11 manufacturing facilities. Identified 47 critical vulnerabilities and developed remediation roadmap.
- **2019 (Q1):** ERP Advisory -- selected as independent advisor for ACME's \$85M SAP S/4HANA implementation. Provided program governance, change management, and quality assurance over 24 months.
- **2020 (Q3):** Transfer Pricing Study -- documented intercompany pricing for cross-border transactions between US, Mexico, Germany, China, and India operations.
- **2021 (Q1):** Post-Merger Integration -- advised on integration of Vertex Precision Components (\$420M acquisition), including Day 1 readiness, synergy tracking, and cultural integration.
- **2022 (Q2):** Tax Compliance Transition -- assumed global tax compliance from prior provider. Consolidated 8 local firms into coordinated Meridian delivery.
- **2023 (Q1):** Supply Chain Resilience Study -- developed multi-tier supply chain risk model following pandemic disruptions. Identified alternative sourcing strategies for 340 critical components.
- **2024 (Q2):** ESG Reporting Advisory -- assisted with first voluntary CSRD-aligned sustainability report and limited assurance engagement.
- **2025 (Q1):** Cybersecurity Maturity Assessment -- reassessment and NIST CSF 2.0 alignment across all operations. Supported preparation for SEC cybersecurity disclosure requirements.
- **2025 (Q4):** R&D Tax Credit Study -- identified \$14.2M in previously unclaimed federal and state R&D tax credits for

FY2022-2024.

### 3. Current Active Engagements

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#### Internal Audit Co-Sourcing (Ongoing)

**Annual Fee:** \$1.8M

**Meridian Team Size:** 8 dedicated professionals (1 Director, 2 Managers, 5 Staff)

**Scope:** SOX 404 testing (65 key controls), operational audits (12 per year), compliance reviews, fraud risk assessments

**Engagement Partner:** Sarah Chen

**Client Contact:** VP of Internal Audit, Thomas Nakamura

#### Global Tax Compliance (Ongoing)

**Annual Fee:** \$3.4M

**Scope:** US federal, state (28 states), and international compliance (5 jurisdictions). Transfer pricing documentation. Quarterly ASC 740 provision support.

**Engagement Partner:** James Worthington

**Client Contact:** VP of Tax, Maria Rodriguez

#### ESG Assurance (Annual)

**Annual Fee:** \$420K

**Scope:** Limited assurance on selected ESG metrics per ISAE 3000/3410. Advisory on CSRD readiness.

**Engagement Partner:** Sarah Chen

**Client Contact:** Chief Sustainability Officer, Karen Park

#### Cybersecurity Managed Services (Ongoing)

**Annual Fee:** \$2.6M

**Scope:** Continuous vulnerability management, penetration testing (quarterly), incident response retainer, security awareness training program

**Engagement Partner:** David Kim

**Client Contact:** CISO, Robert Zhang

## 4. Key Outcomes and Value Delivered

Over the course of our 8+ year relationship, Meridian has delivered measurable value to ACME Manufacturing across multiple dimensions:

- **Tax Savings:** \$14.2M in R&D tax credits identified (FY2022-2024); \$2.8M in transfer pricing optimization savings annually
- **Audit Efficiency:** Reduced SOX testing cycle from 16 weeks to 11 weeks through continuous auditing techniques and data analytics
- **ERP Implementation:** SAP S/4HANA delivered on-time and within 3% of budget (\$85M program). Achieved 99.4% data migration accuracy. Reduced month-end close from 12 days to 5 days.
- **Cybersecurity:** Reduced critical vulnerabilities by 87% (from 47 to 6) over 2-year remediation program. Achieved NIST CSF maturity score of 3.8/5.0, up from 2.1.
- **Post-Merger Integration:** Vertex Precision integration completed in 9 months (3 months ahead of plan). Achieved \$18M in Year 1 synergies against \$15M target.
- **Supply Chain:** Identified alternative sourcing for 340 critical components, reducing single-source dependency from 42% to 14%

## 5. Client Satisfaction

**Most Recent CSAT Score:** 4.7 / 5.0 (December 2025 annual survey)

**Net Promoter Score:** +72 (Promoter category)

**Relationship Health Rating:** Green -- strong and growing

ACME has participated in Meridian's annual client satisfaction survey every year since 2018. Scores have consistently exceeded 4.5/5.0. Key themes from qualitative feedback include:

- 'Meridian professionals feel like an extension of our team, not outside consultants'
- 'The partner-level attention we receive is exceptional -- Sarah is always accessible'
- 'Meridian proactively identifies issues and opportunities; they don't wait to be asked'
- 'The quality of deliverables is consistently high across all service lines'
- 'Pricing is fair and transparent -- no surprises'

## 6. Growth Opportunities

The following opportunities have been identified for relationship expansion:

- **External Audit (FY2027):** ACME's current external auditor contract expires December 2026. Management has indicated interest in considering Meridian. Requires independence planning if pursued.
- **AI/ML Advisory:** ACME is evaluating AI applications for predictive maintenance and quality control. Meridian's new AI Advisory practice is well-positioned.
- **International Expansion Advisory:** ACME is considering a manufacturing facility in Vietnam. Meridian can provide site selection, tax structuring, and regulatory compliance advisory.

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## 7. Key Contacts at ACME

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- **CEO:** Richard Hawthorne (relationship: moderate -- annual executive dinner)
- **CFO:** Patricia Williams (relationship: strong -- quarterly meetings with Sarah Chen)
- **VP of Internal Audit:** Thomas Nakamura (relationship: strong -- daily interaction)
- **VP of Tax:** Maria Rodriguez (relationship: strong -- bi-weekly calls)
- **CISO:** Robert Zhang (relationship: strong -- monthly security briefings)
- **Chief Sustainability Officer:** Karen Park (relationship: developing)
- **General Counsel:** Margaret O'Brien (relationship: moderate)